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Social development

Pakistan:* draft resolution**

Access to assistive technology

The General Assembly,

Reaffirming the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development¹ and the commitment therein to achieving sustainable development in its three dimensions – economic, social and environmental – in a balanced and integrated manner, as well as the Sevilla Commitment adopted at the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development,²

Recalling the Universal Declaration of Human Rights,³ the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights,⁴ the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities⁵ and all other relevant obligations of States,

Recalling also its resolutions [80/197](#) of 17 December 2025 on the implementation of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, [78/4](#) of 5 October 2023 on the political declaration of the high-level meeting on universal health coverage and [75/131](#) of 14 December 2020 on the United Nations Decade of Healthy Ageing (2021–2030), the Political Declaration and the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing, 2002,⁶ and World Health Assembly resolution 71.8 of 26 May 2018 on improving access to assistive technology,⁷

Reaffirming the obligations of States Parties to the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities to undertake or promote research and development of, and to promote the availability and use of new technologies, including information and

* Any changes to the list of sponsors will be reflected in the official record of the meeting.

** In order for the General Assembly to take action on the present proposal, it will be necessary to decide to reopen consideration of agenda item 25 and to consider it directly in plenary meeting.

¹ Resolution [70/1](#).

² Resolution [79/323](#), annex.

³ Resolution [217 A \(III\)](#).

⁴ See resolution [2200 A \(XXI\)](#), annex.

⁵ United Nations, *Treaty Series*, vol. 2515, No. 44910.

⁶ *Report of the Second World Assembly on Ageing, Madrid, 8–12 April 2002* (United Nations publication, Sales No. E.02.IV.4), chap. I, resolution 1, annexes I and II.

⁷ See World Health Organization, document WHA71/2018/REC/1.



communications technologies, mobility aids, devices and assistive technology, suitable for persons with disabilities, giving priority to technologies at an affordable cost, and to provide accessible information to persons with disabilities about mobility aids, devices and assistive technology, including new technologies, as well as other forms of assistance, support services and facilities, and in this regard taking note of the work and activities of the Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities and the Special Rapporteur on the rights of persons with disabilities,

Taking note of the World Health Organization and United Nations Children's Fund *Global Report on Assistive Technology*, of 2022,

Recognizing that currently two and a half billion people, including children, adults, older persons, persons with disabilities and those with health conditions, including noncommunicable and communicable diseases, need assistive technology and that there is considerable inequity among and within countries, with as few as 3 per cent having access in some settings due to persistent barriers, including physical, environmental and attitudinal,

Acknowledging that improving access to assistive technology for all those who benefit from it would contribute to the achievement of the 2030 Agenda and ensuring that no one is left behind, and noting that the full and effective inclusion and participation of those who benefit from assistive technology, including persons with disabilities, older persons and people with health conditions, is crucial for creating inclusive societies,

Recognizing that assistive technology has shown its potential to strengthen the fulfilment of human rights, and that it can create conditions enabling all those who benefit from assistive technology, including persons with disabilities, to fully enjoy their human rights and can contribute to their empowerment and allow them to live independently in the community and to fully, effectively and meaningfully participate in society and in the workplace,

Noting that assistive technology includes assistive products that maintain or improve physical, sensory, cognitive, communication and daily functioning of all those who benefit from assistive technology, and that related policy, systems and services, including trained personnel, may be required to support their provision, and recognizing the need to improve assistive technology systems by developing and strengthening their five components, namely people-centred care, products, provision, personnel and policies, and, where possible, integrating assistive technology within health, education and social services and systems,

Expressing concern at the persistent barriers in accessing assistive technology, including lack of awareness, of affordability due to high costs, and of suitably trained personnel, limited physical and geographical access to services, inadequate product range, quality, suitability, upkeep or ongoing maintenance, procurement and delivery challenges, disparity in access to and usage of digital technology, and inadequate policies, access to technology and financing,

Concerned about the affordability of accessing assistive technology, and inequitable access to such products within and among countries, as well as the financial hardships associated with high prices, which impede progress towards achieving universal access to healthcare,

Recognizing that, while Governments are primarily responsible for the provision of assistive technology to address the needs of their own population, complementary external funding from all sources for assistive technology may be needed to support the strengthening of assistive technology systems for many countries, at least in the short to medium term,

1. *Stresses* the need to scale up efforts to establish and strengthen people-centred sustainable assistive technology access across all domains, focused in particular on the needs of the poorest and hardest to reach, taking into account the need for quality, affordable products and provision models, adequate personnel with role-specific competencies, policy coherence and financing mechanisms;
2. *Urges* Member States to ensure access to assistive technology and to mobilize the necessary resources and support in this regard, ensuring a comprehensive, evidence-based, multisectoral and integrated approach, including through coordinated national strategies and plans of action, that involves health, education, labour, social protection and other relevant sectors;
3. *Calls upon* Member States to create an enabling environment, including through international cooperation, and to develop and regularly review a national essential or priority assistive products list according to population needs and available resources, and support national research and innovation programmes for assistive technology, underlining the importance of developing efficient and innovative approaches;
4. *Encourages* Member States to implement disaggregated data collection, including on the need for, access to and supply of assistive technology, to understand the gaps and trends;
5. *Also encourages* Member States to ensure the full, effective and meaningful participation of those who use and benefit from assistive technology and organizations of persons with disabilities and older persons in all stages of policymaking and decision-making in the process of strengthening assistive technology policies and programmes;
6. *Calls upon* States to systematically include access to assistive technology in humanitarian preparedness plans and response, including for armed conflicts and disasters caused by natural or human-made hazards and in preparing for and responding to emergencies, by strengthening assistive technology capacities ahead of humanitarian emergencies at the national, regional and international levels in line with national contexts and priorities;
7. *Invites* United Nations entities to assist States, upon their request, to strengthen access to assistive technology for all those who benefit from it, and to coordinate actions within the United Nations system in support of global efforts to achieve universal access to assistive technology;
8. *Calls upon* Member States, international financial institutions, donors and development partners to provide technical and economic assistance through international cooperation to support national efforts in increasing access to assistive technology towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals by 2030 and leaving no one behind;
9. *Requests* the Secretary-General, within existing resources, in close collaboration with the relevant United Nations entities, and in consultation with relevant stakeholders, to take the steps necessary to effectively coordinate and follow up on the implementation of the present resolution.